Goldman Sachs Research

Portfolio Strategy Research
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GOAL: GLOBAL OPPORTUNITY ASSET LOCATOR

Giving credit to balance — bonds gradually moving from headwind to hedge

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- Risky assets have consolidated since the summer as rates and energy-price headwinds increasingly offset earnings tailwinds. Global equities have largely moved sideways despite healthy earnings, with the pressure concentrated in rate-sensitive areas such as small caps, real estate and infrastructure. Rising yields have also started to weigh on credit, with widening corporate spreads and a repricing of Euro area sovereign risk.
- We shift back to an OW equities stance for 3m (in line with 12m). Earnings growth remains supportive for equities and the recent valuation de-rating has improved asymmetry into the Q3 earnings season. We shift OW bonds for 12m, as we increasingly see long duration bonds offering better medium-term value as inflation normalises and central bank pricing becomes less hawkish; tactically we still prefer shorter duration fixed income (OW cash).
- Our macro baseline remains constructive: growth should stay healthy, especially for earnings, recession risk remains low, and inflation momentum should moderate into 2027. This combination of resilient growth and easing inflation points to more of a 'Goldilocks' backdrop, which should be more supportive for balanced portfolios.
- We believe bonds should gradually move from portfolio headwind to hedge. While higher yields, fiscal concerns, AI-related capital competition and inflation uncertainty still argue for tactical caution on duration, the combination of higher carry, improved return asymmetry and lower expected inflation points to more normal strategic allocations to bonds.
- We continue to favour equities over credit. Equity valuations have de-rated despite robust earnings growth, while credit spreads remain tight relative to all-in yields and face both releveraging and supply headwinds. Within equities, we favour a barbell of AI beneficiaries and selective rate-sensitive, high-dividend and low-volatility stocks that could benefit from eventual rate relief.
- Near term, rates volatility, Middle East tensions and US midterm-election uncertainty are likely to keep markets volatile. We would use call options to add selectively to equities but maintain tactical cash balances. Front-end receivers, VIX call spreads and targeted FX hedges continue to offer attractive protection against a more material tightening in financial conditions.

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Giving credit to balance — bonds gradually moving from headwind to hedge

1. Risky assets have consolidated since the start of the summer with rates and energy price headwinds taking over from earnings growth tailwinds in 2H. Upward pressure on global bond yields has picked up due to a combination of sticky inflation and resilient growth resulting in more hawkish central banks, but also fiscal concerns coupled with increasing capital competition due to the financing of the AI capex boom. Global equities in aggregate have been range-bound despite continued strong underlying earnings growth – as a result they de-rated materially alongside rising bond yields. Underneath the surface there has been pressure on rate sensitive parts such as small and mid caps as well as bond proxy sectors and styles, including real estate and infrastructure. More recently rates pressures have also started to weigh on credit with a sharp increase in corporate credit spreads and more recently a repricing of Euro area sovereign spreads.

We are shifting back to our OW equities for 3m, in line with our 12m allocation. We continue to think earnings growth remains supportive for equities and following the valuation de-rating and positioning declines since the summer, there is better asymmetry with potential for valuation expansion in the event of rates relief. **However, to create more balance we shift OW bonds on a 12m horizon – we remain N on a 3m horizon and prefer shorter duration fixed income (shift OW cash).** With our macro baseline of inflation normalisation, peaking energy prices and dovish views on central banks, allocations to bonds are becoming more attractive for investors with longer investment horizons – near term, the rates picture is complicated by the Middle East tensions, US midterm election uncertainty and the AI capex boom. **We shift back to UW credit for the 3m horizon, in line with our 12m allocation.** We continue to prefer equity vs. credit – even after the recent credit spread widening, we see relatively poor asymmetry for excess returns relative to equities, also considering continued issuance and releveraging.

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Exhibit 1: Modestly pro-risk but more focused on balance and UW credit

3-Month Horizon	
Asset Class	**Weight***
Equities	**OW**
MSCI Asia Pac ex Japan	↑
TOPIX	↑
S&P 500	↑
STOXX Europe 600	↓
Cash	**OW**
10 yr. Gov. Bonds	**N**
US	↑
Germany	↑
UK	→
Japan	↓
Commodities	**N**
S&P GSCI Precious Metals	↑
S&P GSCI Energy	→
S&P GSCI Industrial Metals	→
Credit	**UW**
USD IG	↑
USD HY	↑
EM USD	→
EUR HY	↓
EUR IG	↓

12-Month Horizon	
Asset Class	**Weight***
Equities	**OW**
MSCI Asia Pac ex Japan	↑
S&P 500	↑
TOPIX	↑
STOXX Europe 600	↓
10 yr. Gov. Bonds	**OW**
US	↑
Germany	↑
UK	↑
Japan	↓
Commodities	**N**
S&P GSCI Precious Metals	↑
S&P GSCI Energy	→
S&P GSCI Industrial Metals	→
Cash	**N**
Credit	**UW**
USD IG	↑
USD HY	↑
EM USD	→
EUR HY	↓
EUR IG	↓

** Arrows denote preferences within asset classes.*

Source: Goldman Sachs Global Investment Research

We shift back to OW equities for 3m and remain OW for 12m. Global equities consolidated over the summer with fading earnings tailwinds but increasing rates headwinds. As a result the valuation de-rating, which started at the beginning of the year, has extended further. Rising yields have weighed particularly on rate sensitive parts within the equity market while Tech stocks were supported by strong earnings growth. Our equity strategy teams continue to expect solid earnings growth into year-end and, while it should moderate in 2027, levels remain healthy – our US team still expects 18% S&P 500 earnings growth in 2027, excluding "other income" related to revaluation of equity stakes. We also expect the upcoming Q3 earnings seasons to surprise to the upside, both in the US and Europe. In addition, while not our baseline, there is potential for some valuation expansion in the event of rates relief and with positive momentum behind AI applications and adoption driving tangible revenues and better profitability. The main near-term downside risk to equities remains higher rates and energy prices – also, US midterm election uncertainty could lead to a pick-up in equity volatility from current low levels. We remain OW Asia/US, UW Europe and favour a more balanced style/sector allocation across regions – we like a barbell strategy of global Tech stocks with selective rate sensitive, low vol/high dividend/bond proxy stocks, which have de-rated since the summer.

We remain N bonds for 3m and shift to OW for 12m. The global bond sell-off accelerated owing to sticky inflation and Middle East tensions combined with resilient growth, fiscal concerns, hawkish central banks and intensifying capital competition from the AI capex boom. The rise has been led by front-end and real yields, leaving market pricing considerably more hawkish than our economists' baseline, which assumes limited core inflationary pressures will constrain central bank tightening. Given our baseline of normalising inflation, peaking energy prices and more dovish central banks, 10-year bonds should gradually move from headwind to hedge in portfolios. Near term, however, we prefer shorter-duration bonds and remain overweight cash. Although front-end rates

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are increasingly skewed to the downside, energy-price volatility and monetary policy uncertainty remain elevated. The clearest route to a near-term peak in global yields would be tighter financial conditions weakening growth sentiment; recent pressure in corporate and sovereign credit suggests the sell-off may already be approaching a speed limit. The Euro area sovereign risk concerns also generated a relative safety bid, with US, German and UK 10-year bonds rallying as OAT spreads widened. We remain overweight the US, UK and Germany, and underweight Japan for 12m (UK N for 3m).

We shift UW credit for 3m and remain UW for 12m. Credit has underperformed equities in the recent 'risk off' environment, extending the underperformance YTD. After the recent widening owing to elevated rates volatility and continued concerns on supply, credit spreads are close to our credit strategy team's year-end targets. They see potential for some typical year-end spread tightening, which is often visible in late December, as the pace of supply slows. However, they see risks to their forecasts as tilted towards more widening. While all-in yields are higher, credit spreads remain relatively low – for example for the USD IG corporate index, the credit spread accounts for only 15% of the yield (compared with 45% on average in recent years). Our credit strategy team continues to prefer USD over EUR credit because of a more supportive growth, inflation and policy mix, alongside rising Euro sovereign risk premia – they have shifted N IG versus HY. The team prefers HY bonds to leveraged loans and agency MBS to IG, and is UW EUR AT1s versus HY. We remain N EM USD credit. Our EM strategy team expects credit spreads to be more rangebound after the recent widening.

We remain N commodities. Commodities remain volatile given Middle East tensions, while more hawkish central banks and rising real rates have also weighed on Gold. We continue to expect a normalisation of energy prices into year-end but uncertainty remains high. According to our commodities team, Persian Gulf oil exports (including "dark exports") are back to pre-war levels, although Dec26 Brent oil futures have remained above US$100/bbl with more Iranian attacks on tankers. In addition, refined products such as Gasoline/Diesel and TTF gas prices remain near their YTD highs and well above their March highs. Our commodities team continues to recommend hedging geopolitical risk through long 2027 positions in European gasoline. They estimate TTF could rally to 150 EUR/MWh by year-end in a scenario where Persian Gulf LNG exports don't improve and the winter is colder than average. Finally, they lowered their year-end Gold price target to $4,650/toz (from $4,900/toz) as a more hawkish Fed might weigh on ETF demand in the near term. Continued central bank diversification remains the main structural driver of their constructive gold view, contributing nearly all of our expected 23% appreciation through end-2027 ($5,400/toz). We also see more value in Gold for European investors that try to reduce EUR exposure and hedge further increases in EU sovereign risk premia.

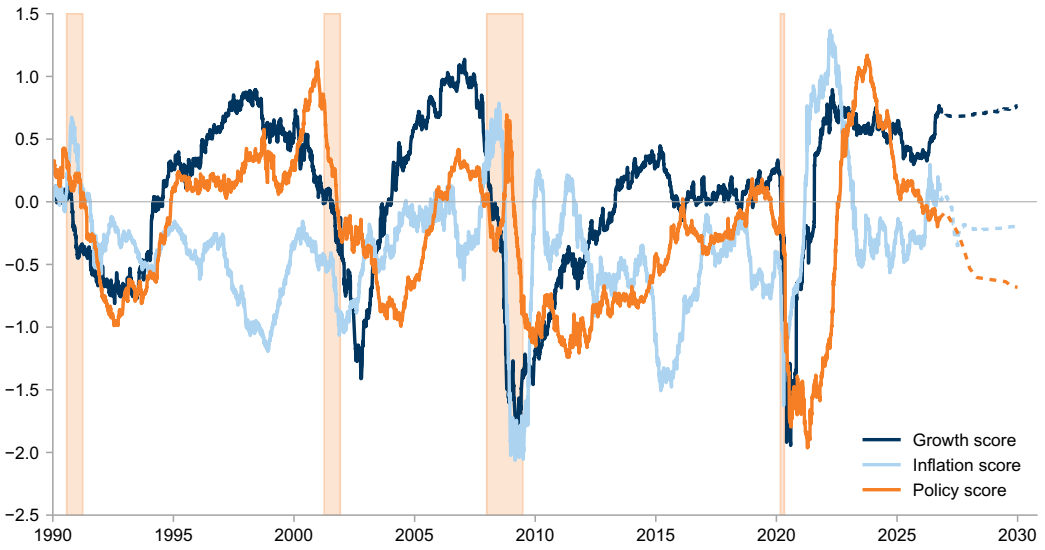
We shift OW cash for 3m and remain N for 12m. Near term, elevated rates volatility, Middle East tensions and uncertainty surrounding the US midterm elections are likely to keep portfolio risk high. However, given our constructive equity outlook, we would buy dips into year-end and favour short-duration fixed income to preserve dry powder. We continue to look for selective defensive overlay trades to protect equity positions – see the last bullet.

2. Nominal growth momentum is nearing its peak after the acceleration YTD. Our US economists continue to expect sturdy growth with a stable labour market and low US recession risk. However, the US economy is increasingly bifurcated with strength among

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upper-income consumers and AI-exposed sectors but weaker growth elsewhere – areas such as housing and consumer spending have suffered from higher rates and gas prices respectively. That said, with US growth close to trend in the coming quarters and a stable unemployment rate in our economists' macro baseline, our growth score should remain stable at elevated levels in the coming months (Exhibit 2). On the flip side our inflation score is close to peaking and with our forecast for falling energy prices and normalising core inflation it should decline back into negative territory in 2027 – this should limit central bank tightening and would result in the policy score resuming its downtrend.

Exhibit 2: Nominal growth has accelerated but inflation momentum should turn more negative
Average expanding z-score of macro and market variables across growth, inflation and policy. Dotted line based on GIR forecasts



Source: Haver Analytics, Bloomberg, Datastream, Goldman Sachs Global Investment Research

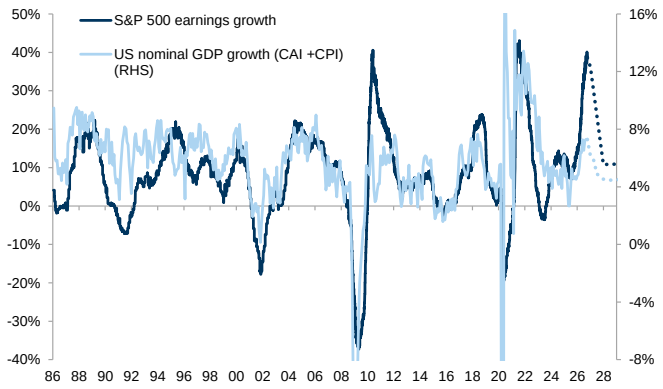
The decline in nominal growth momentum, with normalising inflation but real growth staying close to trend, points to a return to a 'Goldilocks'-like backdrop (Exhibit 3). Most of the decline in nominal growth momentum is due to inflation normalising. In fact, based on our forecasts the gap between S&P 500 earnings growth and US nominal GDP growth is likely to remain among the widest since the 1980s due to the AI capex boom boosting earnings growth. While our US strategy team has argued that they do not see an 'earnings bubble', companies are now 'over-earning' because of gains on private investment stakes and margin expansion for semiconductor and memory companies due to the AI capex boom. However, they still expect S&P 500 earnings growth of 11% in both 2027 and 2028 (and 18% in 2027 excluding base effects from the revaluation of equity stakes).

A renewed decline in inflation momentum would be a high quality signal of a shift towards a more supportive Goldilocks backdrop. Market-based inflation momentum fell sharply in Q2, ahead of the macro data, as energy prices and breakeven inflation declined, unlocking rate relief and supporting risky assets. Since Q3, however, it has risen again amid higher energy prices and ongoing Middle East tensions. Beyond oil, concerns are growing about persistent pressure on refined products such as diesel and gasoline, as well as TTF gas prices. Central banks' hawkish summer shift has also driven a substantial repricing of hiking cycles: markets now price more than three further Fed

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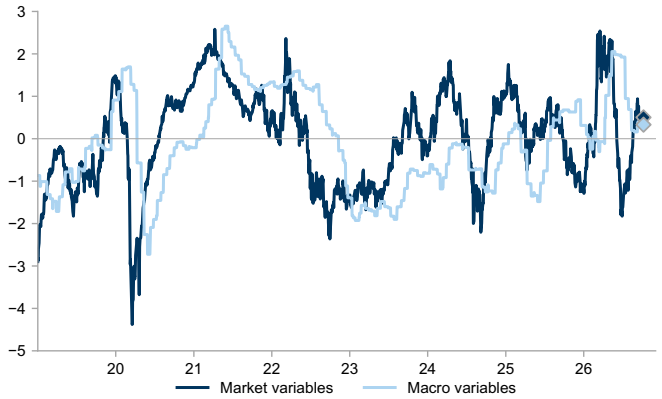
hikes, at least two from the ECB and nearly four from the BoE. By contrast, our economists expect only one more hike from each, with potential cuts beginning next year.

Exhibit 3: Growth momentum should peak but earnings are still materially outstripping nominal GDP
yoy nominal GDP growth vs. earnings growth (dotted lines denote GIR forecasts)



Source: Datastream, Haver Analytics, Goldman Sachs Global Investment Research

Exhibit 4: Market measures of inflation have started to normalise but macro data not yet
Inflation momentum: 1-year rolling z-score of measures of US inflation

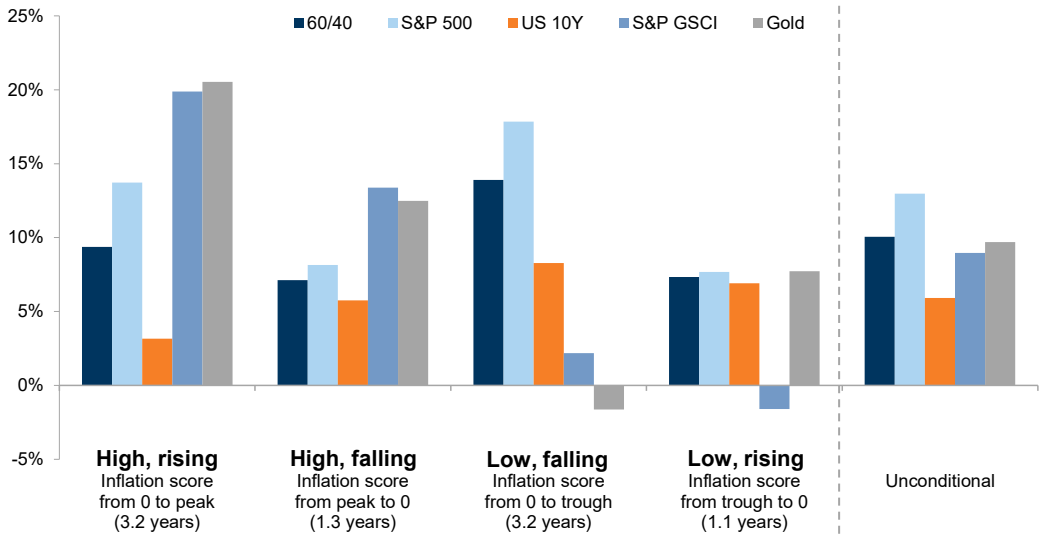


Source: Haver Analytics, Bloomberg, Goldman Sachs Global Investment Research

3. This baseline of strong earnings growth but easing inflation should be more favourable for balanced portfolios in the next 12 months. As we wrote in Global Strategy Paper: Dynamic Balanced Bear, inflation and inflation momentum are a high quality signal for asset allocation and 60/40 portfolios – inflation cycles generally lasted longer than growth cycles and were more persistent. As shown in Exhibit 5, a high inflation score tends to boost commodities and Gold, especially while bonds suffer with positive inflation levels and momentum. This is similar to the regime since the beginning of the year with the Middle East war boosting inflation. Equities have performed best when inflation scores have been low and falling, in line with our baseline into next year – this is also when 60/40 portfolios performed best. Of course, the interaction with growth matters critically.

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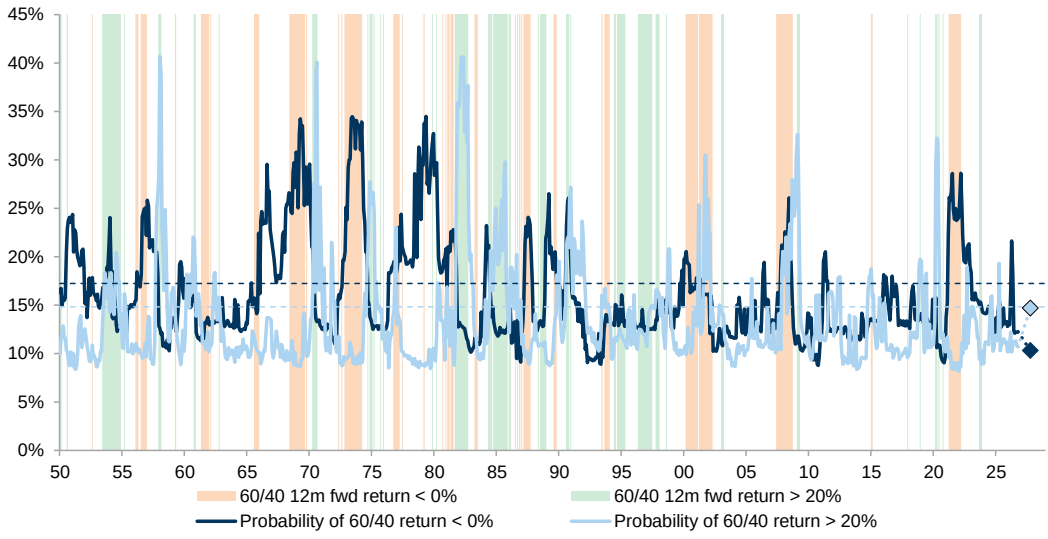
Exhibit 5: 60/40 portfolios tend to perform best when the inflation score is negative and falling
Average 12-month total returns for different inflation regimes (median period length in brackets)



Source: Haver Analytics, Bloomberg, Datastream, Goldman Sachs Global Investment Research

Our dynamic asset allocation (DAA) model, combining the growth/inflation/policy mix, has started to signal less downside risk for 60/40 portfolios in the next 12 months. This is especially true when including our economists' macro baseline – drawdown risk for 60/40 portfolios declines to the low end of the historical range owing to the inflation normalisation and bonds should eventually buffer equities better. Under that baseline right-tail risk (a 60/40 rally of more than 20% in the next 12 months) shifts near the unconditional probability. However, our model does not incorporate the earnings tailwinds from the AI capex boom and thus might understate the upside potential for equities – the same was true for the late 1990s, when our model did not capture the late cycle Tech rally (although it did signal the impending Tech bubble burst).

Exhibit 6: The asymmetry for 60/40 portfolios should improve in the next 12m based on our macro baseline
Diamonds estimated based on GIR forecasts

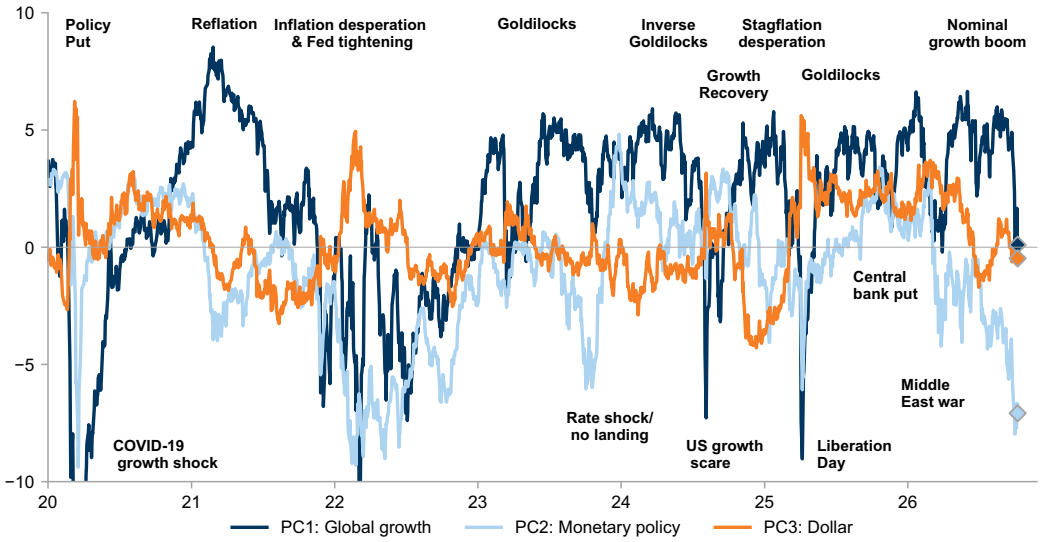


Source: Datastream, Haver Analytics, Goldman Sachs Global Investment Research

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4. More recently, rising rates have weighed more clearly on risk appetite: over the past two weeks, our Risk Appetite Indicator (RAI) has fallen to zero from previously elevated levels. This is not necessarily a bullish signal – historically, a reading near or below -2 has signalled a better opportunity to 'buy the dip', or at least to turn less bearish. However, our RAI principal components illustrate a regime shift – RAI PC1 ('Global Growth') has started to 'catch down' to RAI PC2 ('Monetary Policy') after decoupling for most of the year (Exhibit 7). For most of the year, the RAI has stayed at elevated levels supported by growth sentiment, but recently RAI PC1 has declined, with rate sensitive parts within equities such as small and mid caps suffering, with sharp increases in credit spreads and, more recently, Euro area sovereign spreads. This growth repricing and resulting tightening in financial conditions should eventually slow the bond sell-off.

Exhibit 7: More hawkish rates pricing has started to weigh on growth sentiment
RAI principal components

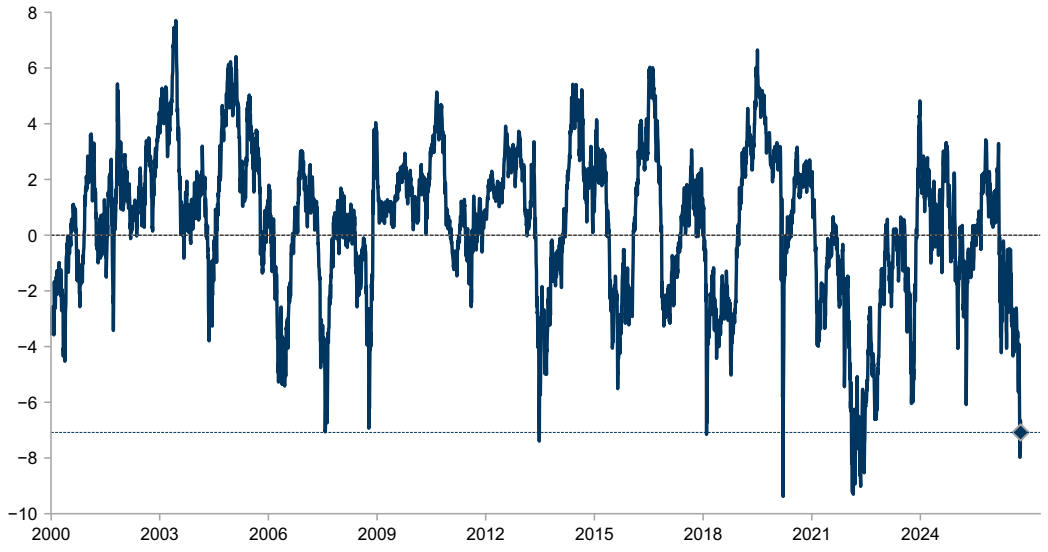


Source: Goldman Sachs Global Investment Research

5. The RAI PC2 has now declined to one of the lowest levels since 2000, indicating the rates drag on risk appetite is becoming particularly extreme (Exhibit 8). The last time monetary policy was a similarly large drag on risk appetite was in 2022, when RAI PC2 remained negative for a long time and materially weighed on RAI PC1 and broader risk appetite until Q4 2022. The RAI credit subcomponent recorded one of its sharpest weekly declines since 2000 – this was most pronounced in Euro area sovereign spreads, particularly France, but extended across corporate and EM credit.

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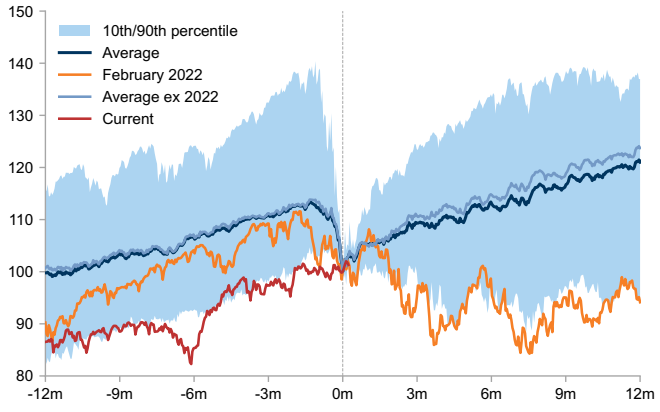
Exhibit 8: Our RAI PC2 "Monetary Policy" factor dropped to one of the lowest levels since 2000



Source: Datastream, Haver Analytics, Goldman Sachs Global Investment Research

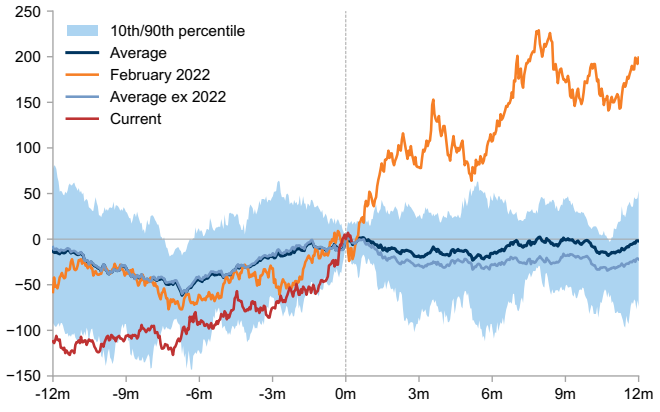
Historically, such sharp declines in RAI PC2 improved the return asymmetry for equities and bonds by increasing the prospect of rate relief. As Exhibit 9 and Exhibit 10 show, across the 11 instances since 2000, the S&P 500 typically corrected before resuming its uptrend, while US 10-year yields remained rangebound over the following 12 months. The main exception was 2022 – in the first three quarters of 2022 US 2-year yields rose by more than 400bp and 10-year yields by more than 350bp from the exceptionally low levels reached during the COVID-19 crisis. Even if central banks tighten in line with current market pricing, the drag from monetary policy should be less extreme. That said, the S&P 500 has not corrected much, in large part because of resilient earnings growth.

Exhibit 9: On average equities recovered after a sharp decline in RAI PC2, except in 2022
Average performance of S&P 500 around 11 RAI PC2 troughs since 2000



Source: Datastream, Goldman Sachs Global Investment Research

Exhibit 10: US 10-year bonds yields peaked around a RAI PC2 low, except in 2022
Average change in US 10-year yields around 11 RAI PC2 troughs since 2000



Source: Datastream, Goldman Sachs Global Investment Research

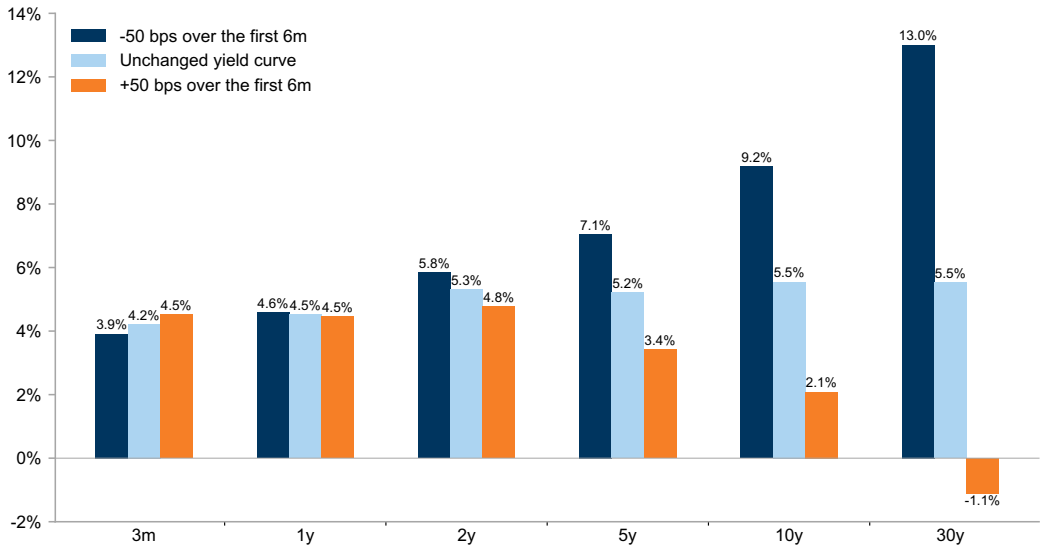
6. However, the near-term path to rate relief remains complicated by the drivers of the bond sell-off and mixed correlation patterns. The rise in US 10-year yields has been driven by front-end and real yields rather than steeper curves, higher term premia or breakeven inflation. This largely reflects a hawkish repricing of central banks amid

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greater uncertainty over central bank reaction functions, stickier inflation, rising capital competition and fiscal concerns that have unsettled longer-dated yields. Although front-end rates are increasingly skewed to the downside, energy-price volatility and related monetary policy uncertainty remain high. The clearest route to a near-term peak in global yields would be tighter financial conditions weighing on growth sentiment; recent pressure in corporate and sovereign credit suggests the bond sell-off may be approaching a speed limit. Increasing EU sovereign spreads also created demand for relative safe havens such as US Treasuries and German bunds.

Even with persistent uncertainty over equilibrium yields, bonds should gradually move from a portfolio headwind towards becoming a more effective hedge. The ongoing AI capex boom and its financing needs, alongside lingering fiscal concerns, have increased uncertainty around the medium-term fair value of bond yields. However, higher carry and reinvestment yields should cushion the impact of further rate increases. As Exhibit 11 shows, higher starting yields give long-duration bonds better asymmetry for longer investment horizons: potential gains from rate relief now exceed the likely losses from a further rise in yields. As we recently wrote, while bonds added little value to portfolios over the past five years, there is a growing case for more normal strategic allocations. The optimal bond weight in a balanced portfolio depends on four factors: relative return, relative risk, diversification benefits and the return on cash. While the near-term case remains mixed, we expect all four to become more favourable for bonds over longer investment horizons.

Exhibit 11: The asymmetry for longer duration bonds improves for longer investment horizons
1-year total return of investing in US bonds with different maturities. Assuming buying a par bond rolled every quarter



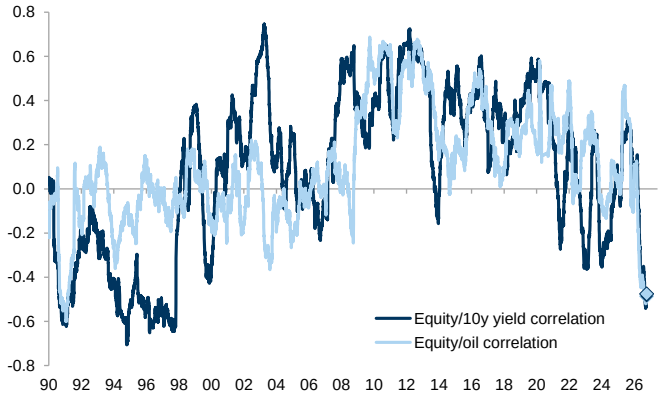
Source: Bloomberg, Datastream, Goldman Sachs Global Investment Research

7. In the near term, energy prices and monetary policy are likely to remain the key drivers of both equities and bonds (Exhibit 12). We therefore prefer shorter-duration fixed income tactically. Rates volatility is likely to remain elevated through the US midterm elections and amid ongoing Middle East tensions, while further sharp increases in yields would probably weigh more heavily on equities than bonds. Historically, yield increases exceeding two standard deviations over three months have been particularly challenging for equity returns (Exhibit 13). For now, additional duration may therefore

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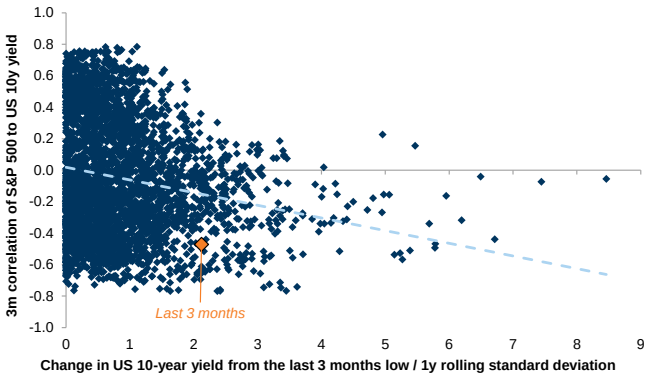
add volatility rather than reliably cushion portfolios. Over 12 months, however, continued inflation normalisation and less hawkish central banks should allow longer-duration bonds to stabilise and gradually recover their diversification benefits.

Exhibit 12: Energy prices and bond yields have become a key driver of equities
6m rolling correlation (weekly returns)



Source: Datastream, Haver Analytics, Goldman Sachs Global Investment Research

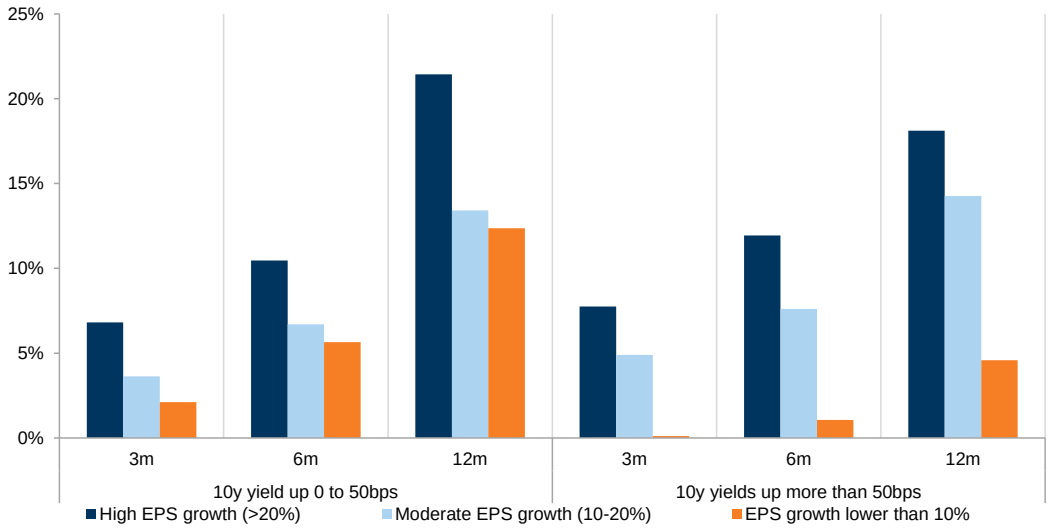
Exhibit 13: A continued sharp increase in bond yields could put pressure on equities
Data since 1962



Source: Datastream, Goldman Sachs Global Investment Research

While bonds have not been able to provide a hedge for equities, equities have been able to buffer higher rates owing to strong earnings growth. While equity/bond correlations remain high on a high-frequency basis, equities have been more resilient owing to underlying strong earnings backdrop – as a result global equities have been rangebound. Also, equity volatility has been relatively anchored due to high dispersion within equity indices – this also makes equity exposure via call options more attractive. As Exhibit 14 shows, historically equities performed well despite rising yields, as long as earnings growth was strong. While there is potential for more rates volatility in the near term, we would look to increase equity exposure into year-end with potential support from the impending Q3 earnings seasons and as valuations have de-rated since the summer.

Exhibit 14: Equities can buffer higher bond yields as long as there is strong earnings growth
Average S&P 500 return in function of yield moves and earnings growth (data since 1950)

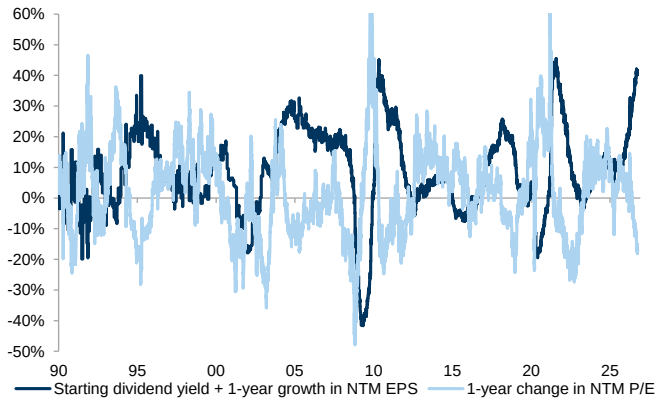


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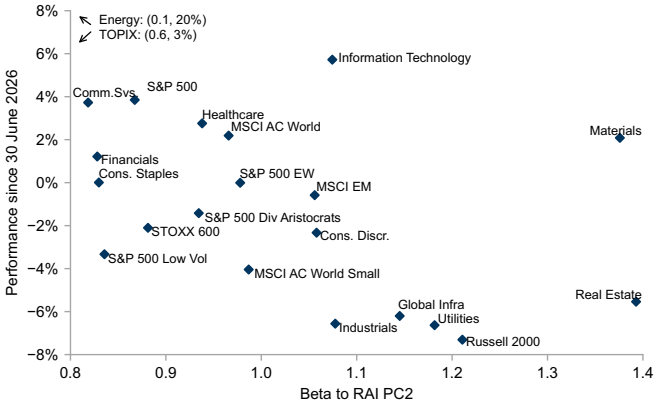
8. MSCI AC World 12-month forward P/E ratios have fallen nearly 20% year to date – an unusually large late-cycle de-rating (Exhibit 15). Typically, the strongest earnings growth occurs in the recovery from a profit recession as markets enter a mid cycle backdrop. This time, however, the AI capex boom has accelerated earnings growth from a later cycle starting point, marked by already low unemployment, positive output gaps and elevated profit margins. The earnings boom has been closely linked to the releveraging around the AI capex – private sector leverage was lower than previous late-cycle episodes. Stronger earnings have boosted prospective equity carry and helped cushion global equities against higher yields. More rate-sensitive areas without the same earnings support have come under greater pressure: infrastructure, real estate and bond-proxy sectors have suffered outright drawdowns since the summer (Exhibit 16).

Exhibit 15: Global equities have de-rated materially with 12m forward P/E ratios down 20%



Source: Datastream, Goldman Sachs Global Investment Research

Exhibit 16: Rate-sensitive sectors have underperformed more clearly with Tech and commodities decoupling
3y beta to RAI PC1 "Global growth" and PC2 "Monetary policy"

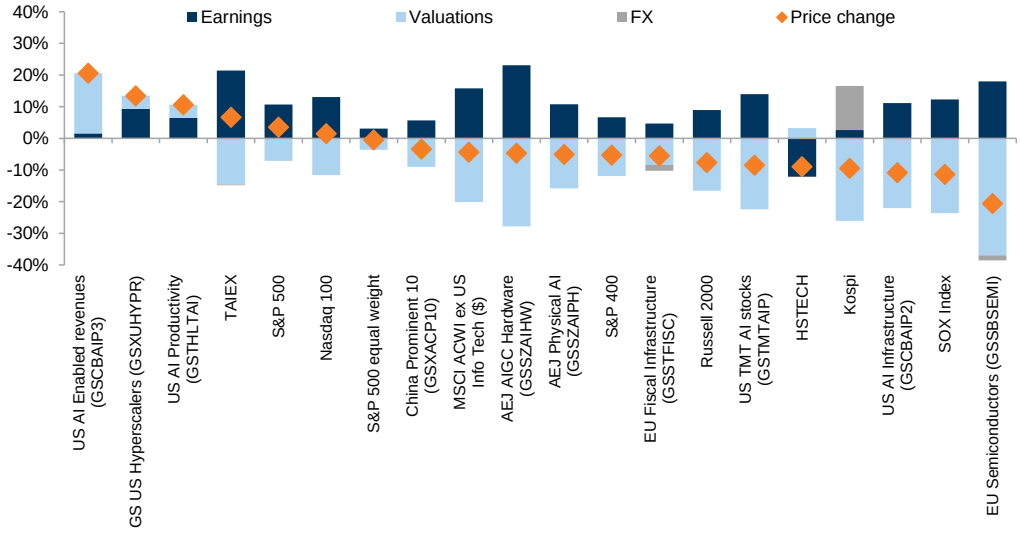


Source: Datastream, Haver Analytics, Goldman Sachs Global Investment Research

The largest valuation de-ratings have been driven by strong earnings in technology, particularly hardware, although some segments have also re-rated (Exhibit 17). As our US strategy team has highlighted, concerns about durability of the earnings for AI infrastructure stocks have weighed on valuations – at current valuations earnings would have to decline materially to return to long-run average levels. Hyperscalers also trade at relatively low earnings multiples owing to concerns on long-term profitability. However, following Meta's launch of Muse and the growing focus on AI applications and adoption, valuations have expanded for companies benefiting from AI-related revenues or productivity gains.

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Exhibit 17: AI-related stocks have been more driven by earnings than valuations, in contrast to other markets
Return decomposition since June 2026 in US$



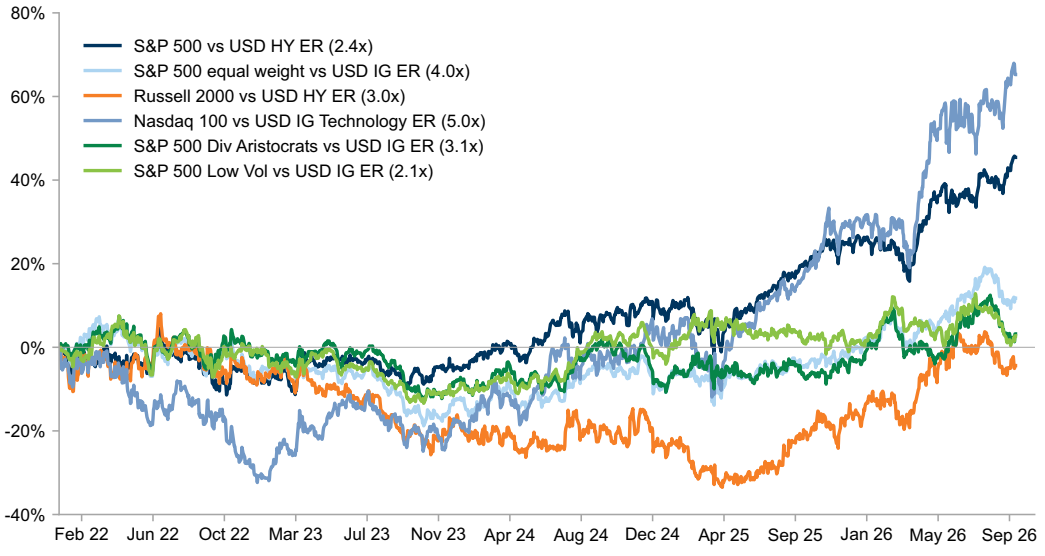
Tickers starting in GSX*, GSCB*, GSTMTAI are baskets developed by GS Global Banking & Markets

Source: Datastream, Factset, Goldman Sachs FICC and Equities, Goldman Sachs Global Investment Research

9. Credit has underperformed vs. Tech-dominated benchmarks but outperformed vs. S&P 500 equal-weight and rate sensitive parts. Equities have continued to outperform credit on a headline level but this has been mostly due to the resilience of the Tech sector – Nasdaq has performed particularly strongly relative to USD IG technology credit (Exhibit 18). However, S&P 500 equal-weight, Russell 2000 and defensive equities have underperformed credit on a risk-adjusted basis since the summer. We remain UW credit – while all-in yields have picked up, this is mostly due to sovereign yields; credit spreads as a proportion of all-in yields are at a new low. We like a barbell strategy of Tech stocks and bond-like equities, which could benefit from rates relief but also start to decouple in the event of more serious de-risking in Tech stocks or broader growth concerns.

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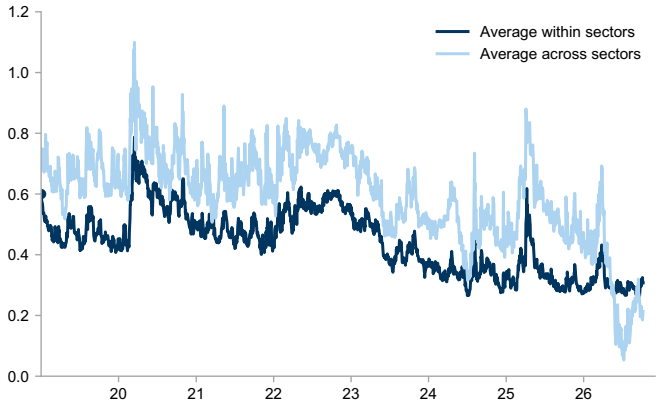
Exhibit 18: Tech stocks have outperformed credit but bond proxies have lagged
Equity vs credit performance (5y beta-adjusted)



Source: Datastream, Haver Analytics, Bloomberg, Goldman Sachs Global Investment Research

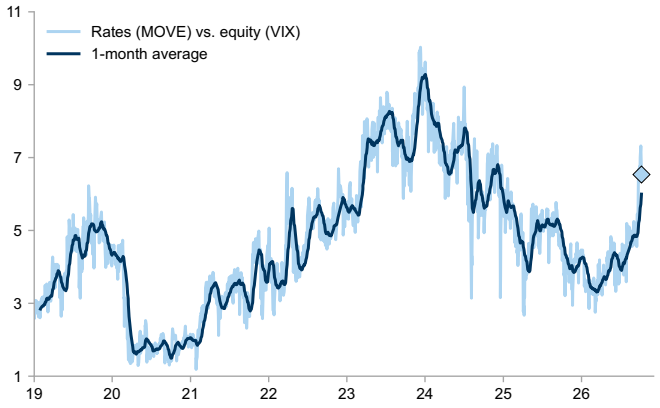
10. Selective option hedges continue to look attractive, with anchored implied vols across most assets. Overall, cross-asset implied volatility remains low, with the VIX at 15 and FX volatility similarly anchored. Credit implied volatility has picked up but remains low relative to history. Within equities, unusually high dispersion has kept index-level volatility contained, with implied correlations close to historical lows across all regions. This reflects not only low correlations among stocks within the same sectors, but also very low correlations across sectors in the index (Exhibit 19). As a result, equity upside hedges into year-end are inexpensive, particularly in rate-sensitive areas of the market. By contrast, rates volatility has risen sharply alongside the bond sell-off over the summer, pushing the MOVE-to-VIX ratio to its highest level since 2024 (Exhibit 20). As discussed above, further sharp increases in rates are likely to weigh more on equities; tactically, we would sell payers on back-end rates to fund equity puts.

Exhibit 19: Implied correlations are extremely low both within and across sectors
3m implied correlation within and across S&P 500 sectors



Source: LSEG Data & Analytics, Goldman Sachs FICC and Equities, Goldman Sachs Global Investment Research

Exhibit 20: Rates volatility has risen relative to equity volatility, but has started to reset recently
Diamond: latest datapoint



Source: LSEG Data & Analytics, Goldman Sachs Global Investment Research

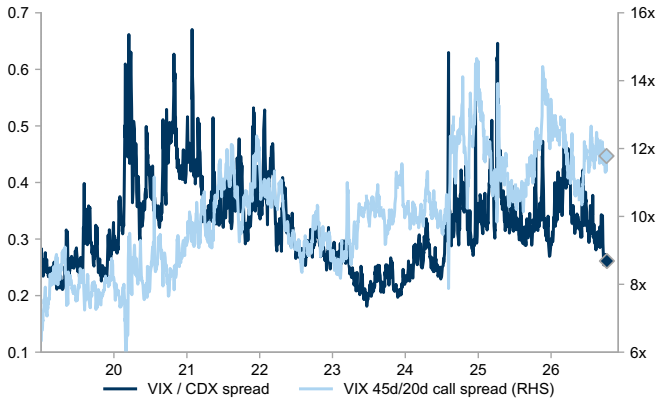
VIX call spreads look attractive as broad downside hedges into year-end, with max-payoff ratios high relative to history (Exhibit 21). As discussed above, elevated

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dispersion has kept the VIX low, but a broader macro shock could drive correlations sharply higher; the VIX also remains low relative to other risk measures, including CDS spreads. For a more targeted hedge against rising Euro area fiscal risk, puts on EUR/USD and EUR/CHF look attractive, although they are less likely to pay off unless sovereign stress broadens across the region.

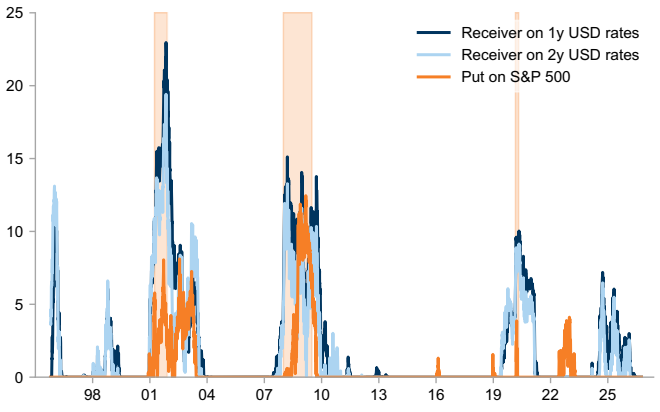
Front-end receiver swaptions offer a more convex recession hedge, with central banks likely to remain responsive to extreme financial conditions tightening. Front-end forward rates have risen sharply YTD, creating an attractive entry point: receivers could benefit both from the central-bank put in a downturn and from near-term rate relief if energy prices decline. In previous recessions, a receiver swaption on short-dated rates would have delivered a larger payoff than an out-of-the-money S&P 500 put (Exhibit 22, based on current prices).

Exhibit 21: VIX call spreads offer an attractive payoff
3m VIX call spread



Source: LSEG Data & Analytics, Goldman Sachs FICC and Equities, Goldman Sachs Global Investment Research

Exhibit 22: Front-end receivers look attractive as medium-term recession hedges
Simulated PnL of a 12m 25-delta receiver on 1y or 2y USD rates and put on S&P 500 (current market price). Shaded area= US recession



Source: Goldman Sachs FICC and Equities, Haver Analytics, Goldman Sachs Global Investment Research

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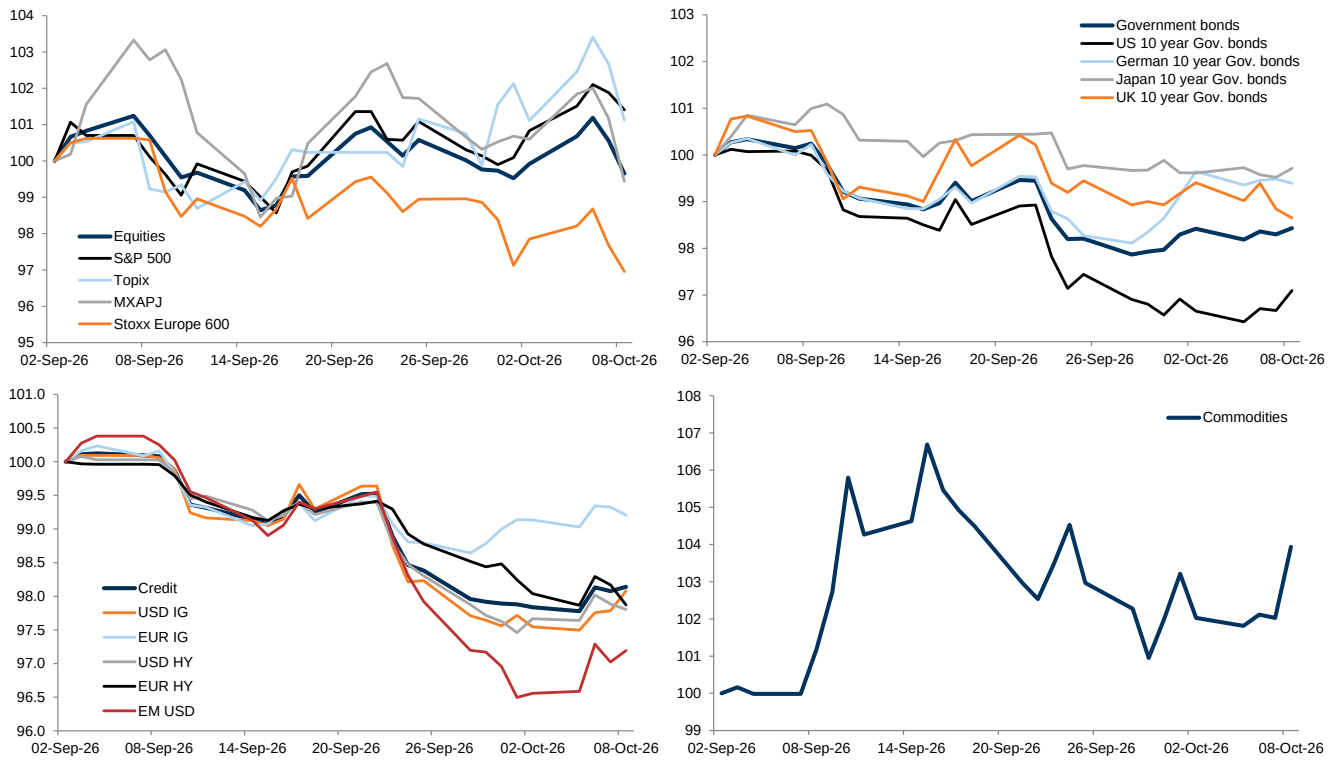
Asset class forecast returns and performance

Exhibit 23: Goldman Sachs' 3-, 6- and 12-month return forecasts by asset class

Asset Class	Benchmark Weight	3-month Total Return		6-month Total Return		12-month Total Return	
		Local currency	In USD	Local currency	In USD	Local currency	In USD
Equities	**35**	**6.7**	**7.3**	**11.3**	**11.6**	**17.2**	**18.0**
S&P 500	40	3.3	3.3	7.5	7.5	13.2	13.2
STOXX Europe 600	30	8.0	9.8	10.4	10.4	14.5	14.5
MSCI Asia Pac ex Japan	20	10.9	11.0	20.4	20.9	30.3	31.4
TOPIX	10	8.1	8.3	11.1	13.4	14.7	21.0
10 yr. Government Bonds	**45**	**4.0**	**4.8**	**5.6**	**5.5**	**8.9**	**9.1**
US	40	5.2	5.2	7.4	7.4	11.8	11.8
Germany	40	3.0	4.8	4.0	4.0	6.0	6.0
Japan	10	1.9	2.0	3.4	5.5	6.5	12.3
UK	10	5.3	5.9	7.0	4.3	10.9	7.3
Credit	**10**	**3.9**	**4.5**	**6.0**	**6.0**	**10.0**	**10.0**
Bloomberg USD IG	40	4.7	4.7	7.1	7.1	11.8	11.8
Bloomberg USD HY	20	3.8	3.8	6.2	6.2	10.9	10.9
Bloomberg EUR IG	20	2.5	4.3	3.7	3.7	6.1	6.0
Bloomberg EUR HY	10	3.2	5.0	4.8	4.7	7.9	7.9
EM Hard Currency Sovereign	10	4.7	4.7	6.8	6.8	11.3	11.3
Commodities (S&P GSCI)	**5**	**-10.8**	**-10.8**	**-7.2**	**-7.2**	**-7.6**	**-7.6**
S&P GSCI Energy	70	-19.2	-19.2	-13.4	-13.4	-15.4	-15.4
S&P GSCI Precious Metals	15	10.1	10.1	13.3	13.3	19.9	19.9
S&P GSCI Industrial Metals	15	-3.2	-3.2	-3.3	-3.3	-3.6	-3.6
Cash	**5**	**0.8**	**1.7**	**1.7**	**1.7**	**3.6**	**3.6**
US	50	1.0	1.0	2.2	2.2	4.4	4.4
Euro area	50	0.6	2.4	1.3	1.3	2.8	2.7
FX		**3m target**	**Return**	**6m target**	**Return**	**12m target**	**Return**
EUR/$		1.14	1.7	1.12	-0.1	1.12	-0.1
$/YEN		158	-0.1	155	-2.0	150	-5.2

Source: Datastream, Bloomberg, Goldman Sachs Global Investment Research

Exhibit 24: Performance of asset classes since our last GOAL (2 September 2026)
Total return in local currency indexed to 100



Source: Datastream, Goldman Sachs Global Investment Research

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Key macro forecasts

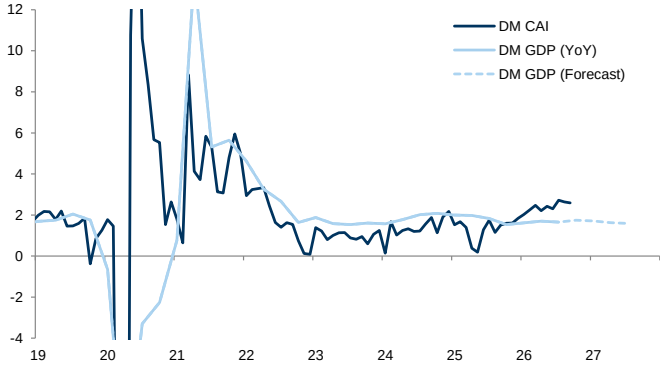
Exhibit 25: GS forecasts across asset classes

	Return in % over last				Current	Forecasts				Up/ (downside) in %		
	12 m	3 m	1 m	YTD	Level	3m	6m	12m	Unit	3m	6m	12m
Equities												
S&P 500 ($)	16.3	4.1	1.3	14.4	7765	8000	8300	8700	Index	3.0	6.9	12.0
Stoxx Europe 600 (€)	12.4	-1.3	-3.6	8.5	626	670	680	695	Index	7.1	8.7	11.1
MSCI Asia-Pacific Ex-Japan ($)	24.6	1.1	-3.2	22.7	870	960	1040	1120	Index	10.4	19.6	28.8
Topix (¥)	29.3	3.1	1.9	22.5	4091	4400	4500	4600	Index	7.5	10.0	12.4
10 Year Government Bond Yields												
US	-3.8	-3.8	-2.9	-4.6	5.23	4.74	4.64	4.45	%	-49 bps	-59 bps	-78 bps
Germany	-3.1	-2.2	-0.8	-2.3	3.49	3.25	3.25	3.25	%	-24 bps	-24 bps	-24 bps
Japan	-8.2	-0.9	-1.3	-5.7	3.09	3.00	2.95	2.84	%	-9 bps	-14 bps	-25 bps
UK	0.1	-1.9	-1.9	-2.7	5.49	5.00	4.99	4.90	%	-49 bps	-49 bps	-59 bps
Credit												
Bloomberg USD IG	-2.0	-2.7	-2.0	-2.6	81	82	80	78	Bps	1 bps	-1 bps	-3 bps
Bloomberg USD HY	1.6	-1.7	-2.2	0.3	310	295	289	280	Bps	-15 bps	-21 bps	-30 bps
Bloomberg EUR IG	-2.0	-2.7	-2.0	-2.6	97	88	86	84	Bps	-9 bps	-11 bps	-13 bps
Bloomberg EUR HY	0.4	-2.2	-2.1	-0.3	344	315	310	305	Bps	-29 bps	-34 bps	-39 bps
EM Hard Currency Sovereign	1.6	-3.1	-3.0	-1.0	189	-	-	200	Bps			11 bps
Commodities												
WTI	55.1	31.8	4.3	71.6	98	79	77	72	$/bbl	-19.6	-21.6	-26.7
Brent	57.4	33.8	6.6	71.6	104	84	82	77	$/bbl	-19.5	-21.4	-26.2
Copper	35.4	10.0	-2.3	15.7	14406	13790	13800	13800	$/mt	-4.3	-4.2	-4.2
Gold	1.9	2.0	-6.6	-4.8	4116	4715	4850	5235	$/troy oz	14.6	17.8	27.2
FX												
EUR/USD	-3.6	-1.7	-3.6	-4.6	1.12	1.14	1.12	1.12		1.7	-0.1	-0.1
USD/JPY	3.7	-2.7	2.7	0.9	158.2	158.0	155.0	150.0		-0.1	-2.0	-5.2
GBP/USD	-1.4	-1.1	-2.4	-1.7	1.32	1.33	1.29	1.28		0.6	-2.5	-3.2
AUD/USD	5.8	0.6	-3.6	4.4	0.70	0.72	0.73	0.74		3.4	4.8	6.3
USD/BRL	-6.3	-2.9	-1.3	-8.5	5.01	5.20	5.10	5.00		3.8	1.8	-0.2
USD/INR	9.0	1.3	2.1	7.7	96.8	96.0	97.0	97.0		-0.8	0.2	0.2
USD/CNY	-5.9	-1.4	-0.1	-4.1	6.70	6.70	6.60	6.40		0.0	-1.5	-4.5

Prices as of October 8th, 2026.

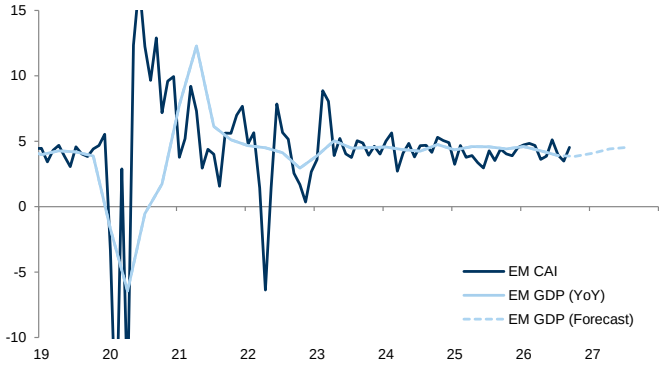
Source: Datastream, Bloomberg, Goldman Sachs Global Investment Research

Exhibit 26: DM GDP growth vs. GS CAI and GDP forecasts



Source: Goldman Sachs Global Investment Research

Exhibit 27: EM GDP growth vs. GS CAI and GDP forecasts



Source: Goldman Sachs Global Investment Research

Exhibit 28: Real GDP growth

*Bloomberg consensus. Aggregates are Market FX - Weighted

% yoy	2025	2026E		2027E	
	GS	GS	Cons.*	GS	Cons.*
USA	2.3	2.3	2.2	2.1	2.2
Japan	1.2	0.9	0.8	1.2	0.8
Euro area	1.3	1.0	0.9	1.2	1.3
UK	1.3	1.4	1.2	1.4	1.2
China	4.9	4.5	4.6	4.6	4.4
India	7.3	7.6	-	7.3	-
Brazil	2.3	2.0	1.9	1.2	1.5
Russia	1.0	0.2	0.8	1.3	1.1
Advanced Economies	1.9	1.8	1.7	1.7	1.8
Emerging Markets	4.2	3.8	3.7	4.0	4.4
World	2.9	2.6	3.0	2.7	3.1

Source: Bloomberg, Goldman Sachs Global Investment Research

Exhibit 29: Headline CPI Inflation

CPI % yoy	2024	2025E	2026E	2027E
USA	3.0	2.7	3.2	2.3
Japan	2.7	3.2	1.8	1.4
Euro area	2.4	2.1	3.0	3.0
UK	2.5	3.4	3.2	2.9
China	0.2	0.1	1.0	1.0
India	5.0	2.2	4.5	5.2
Brazil	4.4	5.0	4.5	4.9
Russia	8.5	8.7	6.0	5.2
Advanced Economies	2.7	2.5	2.9	2.4
Emerging Markets	5.9	4.0	4.3	4.0
World	4.6	3.4	3.8	3.4

Source: Goldman Sachs Global Investment Research

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Reg AC

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Unless otherwise stated, the individuals listed on the cover page of this report are analysts in Goldman Sachs' Global Investment Research division.

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